Homegrown

INTERNAL PLAYBOOK

The First 7 Days: Getting Vendors to Their First Sale

Master Onboarding Playbook — March 2026

Goal: Maximize trial-to-paid conversion, time to first sale (TTFO), and annual plan adoption

42-50%	73%	0	90%
Trial-to-paid (current)	Choose annual plan (current)	Confirmed vendor orders (problem)	Product creation abandonment (problem)

1. The Critical Path

- **To receive orders, vendors need:** (1) at least 1 pickup location, (2) at least 1 product. That's it.
- **The activation moment is NOT setup complete — it's the FIRST ORDER.** Everything after setup must engineer toward sharing the store link.
- **85% of signups are Social Sellers (ICP1) and Farmstand/Porch sellers (ICP2),** not market vendors. The onboarding must speak to all three.

2. Hour-by-Hour Playbook

For each touchpoint: what fires, on what channel, its current status, and what's needed to make it live.

HOUR 0 — Signup Complete

Vendor just created their account and landed on the dashboard

EMAIL TOUCHES

EMAIL	SUBJECT	STATUS	WHAT NEEDS TO HAPPEN
V1 Welcome	"Welcome to Homegrown!"	LIVE (needs refresh)	Refresh: change Step 1 from "Add product" to "Add location". Add trial end date. Add storefront URL.
V3 Trial Start	"Your 7-day free trial just started"	LIVE (needs refresh)	Refresh: lead with trial end date, include 3-step checklist, add dashboard GIF.

DASHBOARD

ELEMENT	CURRENT STATE	PROPOSED STATE	STATUS
Tour modal	"Take the Vendor Dashboard Tour" — 100% dismissed	REMOVE entirely	NEEDS REMOVAL
Progress checklist	Does not exist	3-step checklist: Location → Product → Share	NEEDS DEV
Trial countdown	Not visible anywhere	"Your free trial ends [DATE] — 7 days left" banner at top	NEEDS DEV
Sidebar	9 items shown to new vendors	Simplify to 4 during onboarding (Dashboard, Products, Locations, My Account)	NEEDS DEV

INTERCOM

ELEMENT	CURRENT STATE	PROPOSED STATE	STATUS
Checklist	"Business Information" (profile details)	Replace with "Get your first order" — 3 steps: Location, Product, Share	SUPPORT TASK

PRODUCT (FORM UX)

ELEMENT	CURRENT STATE	PROPOSED STATE	STATUS

Product form	8 fields, images required, SKU prominent	3 required fields (Name, Category, Price), everything else collapsed	NEEDS DEV
Image upload	Required to submit — blocks every mobile vendor	Optional on draft, required before publish only	NEEDS DEV
Validation	Premature red errors on untouched fields	Validate on blur/submit only	NEEDS DEV
Location banner	Covers submit button on mobile	Hide during product creation	NEEDS DEV

HOUR 0 + 2 HOURS — No Product Yet

Vendor signed up but hasn't created a product

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V5	**Subject:** "Your store needs one thing to go live" **Trigger:** subscribed +2h, 0 products **CTA:** "Add your first product"	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED Template at V5-vendor-add-product-nudge-1.html. Needs: register in SendGrid + build trigger logic.

HOUR 0 + 6 HOURS — Still No Product

Photo anxiety is the likely blocker

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V6	**Subject:** "Your phone camera is all you need" **Trigger:** +6h, 0 products (suppress if V5 converted) **Angle:** Photo anxiety — reassure that phone photos are fine	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

HOUR 0 + 12 HOURS — Still No Product

Form complexity is the likely blocker

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V7	**Subject:** "Just 4 fields. Everything else is optional." **Trigger:** +12h, 0 products **Angle:** Form complexity — emphasize minimal requirements	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

DAY 1 — Has Product, No Location

Product created but no pickup location set

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V8	**Subject:** "Your store has products but no pickup — let's fix that" **Trigger:** 1+ products, 0 locations, +24h **CTA:** "Add a pickup location"	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

DAY 2 — Has Product + Location, No Description

Core setup done but profile incomplete

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V9	**Subject:** "Tell customers who you are — it takes 3 minutes" **Trigger:** has product + location, no description, +48h	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

DAY 2-3 — Setup Complete, 0 Orders

The critical activation gap — vendor needs to SHARE their link

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V10	**Subject:** "Your store is ready. Here's how to get your first order." **Trigger:** full setup, 0 orders, +72h **CTA:** "Copy your store link"	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED
Email V11 THE ACTIVATION EMAIL	**Subject:** "Your store is live — here's exactly how to share it" **Must include:** 4 copy-paste templates (Text, Instagram, Facebook, Email) **Trigger:** has product AND location	EXISTS HIGH PRIORITY REFRESH Current version is generic. Must add copy-paste share templates.

COPY-PASTE SHARE TEMPLATES FOR V11

TEXT TO REGULARS

"Hey! I just set up an online store so you can order from me anytime — not just at the market. Check it out: [YOUR LINK]. Order by [DAY] for pickup on [DAY]."

INSTAGRAM POST

"Big news! You can now order my [PRODUCT] online anytime. No more 'save me one!' DMs 😊 Link in bio: [YOUR LINK] #shoplocal #homegrown"

FACEBOOK POST

"I just launched my online store! If you've ever wanted to order between markets, now you can. [YOUR LINK] — orders open now."

EMAIL TO CUSTOMERS

Subject: "You can now order from me online"

"Hi! I wanted to let you know I set up an online ordering page. You can browse my products, place an order, and pick up at [LOCATION]. Here's the link: [YOUR LINK]"

DAY 3-4 — 0 Orders Still

Vendor has setup complete but no traction

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V14-NEW	**Subject:** "5 ways to get your first order this week" **5 tactics:** text 5 regulars, post on Instagram, add to bio, print on card, tell people at market	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

DAY 5 — Trial Day 5

Urgency begins

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V17a	**Subject:** "2 days left to get your first order" If orders > 0: celebrate. If 0: urgency nudge with share CTA.	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

DAY 6 — Trial Day 6

THE conversion email — highest-impact touchpoint for trial-to-paid

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V17b THE CONVERSION EMAIL	**Subject:** "Your store goes offline tomorrow" **Frame:** LOSS — "Your store at [URL] with [X] products goes offline tomorrow. Your [X] profile views disappear." **Primary CTA:** "Keep My Store — $10/mo annual" **Secondary:** "$12.50/mo monthly"	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED **Highest-impact missing email for trial conversion.**

> **Loss aversion is 2x more motivating than gain.** "Your store goes offline" > "Your trial is ending." Always lead with the annual plan ($10/mo) as the primary CTA.

DAY 7 — Trial End

Final conversion window

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V17c	**Subject:** "Your free trial ends today" Simple, direct. Two CTAs: Annual $10/mo (primary) and Monthly $12.50/mo (secondary).	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED
System	If payment method present: auto-converts to paid. If not: V18 fires (exists).	LIVE

DAY 14 — Founder Check-in

Personal touch from Evan

TOUCH	DETAILS	STATUS
Email V21	**Subject:** "Quick check-in from Evan" Plain text, personal, from evan@findhomegrown.com. "Have you gotten any orders? Reply and I'll personally help."	HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED

3. Annual Conversion Strategy

73% of vendors already choose the annual plan without any active promotion. Here's how to push that higher:

TOUCHPOINT	STRATEGY
Day 6 email (V17b)	Lead with annual: "Keep your store — $10/mo" as primary CTA. Monthly ($12.50) as secondary, smaller text.
Day 7 email (V17c)	Same dual-CTA structure. Annual primary, monthly secondary.
Post-first-order celebration	Include annual nudge: "Lock in $10/mo for a year." Ride the dopamine of the first sale.
Day 30 — Monthly vendors (V46)	Annual Upgrade Nudge: "You've paid $12.50 this month. Switch to annual and save $30/year."
Pricing discipline	**Never discount.** $10/mo is already the lowest in market. 90% of subscriptions sell at full price (Adapty data).

4. What Needs to Happen (Build List)

Three categories ranked by who can execute and priority level.

Category A: Support Person Can Do Now (Intercom)

1. **Remove the tour modal video** — 100% of vendors dismiss it immediately
2. **Replace "Business Information" checklist** with "Get your first order" (3 steps: Location, Product, Share)
3. **Set checklist notification style to Snippet** — less intrusive, higher engagement

Category B: Email Team Can Do Now (SendGrid + Triggers)

1. **Refresh V11 (Share Your Profile) with copy-paste templates** — HIGHEST PRIORITY
2. **Register V5, V17b, V17c templates** in SendGrid
3. **Work with dev team to build trigger logic** for time-delay + completion-state checks
4. **Refresh V1** to change step order (location first, not product first)

Category C: Dev Team (Product Changes)

1. Make **images optional on product draft** (required before publish only)
2. Reduce **product form to 3 visible fields** (Name, Category, Price)
3. Add **trial countdown** to dashboard
4. Fix **premature validation** on product form
5. Hide **"Add Location" banner** during product creation
6. Add **3 Intercom trackEvent calls** (location_added, product_added, store_link_shared)
7. Replace **tour modal with progress checklist** in dashboard
8. Add **first-product celebration moment**

5. Success Metrics

METRIC	CURRENT	30-DAY TARGET	90-DAY TARGET
Time to first product	20-45 min	< 10 min	< 5 min
Product creation completion	~10%	50%	80%
% vendors who share link	Unknown (0% tracked)	40%	60%
Time to first sale (TTFO)	Never (0 orders)	72 hours	48 hours
Trial-to-paid	42-50%	55%	65%
Annual plan adoption	73%	80%	85%
30-day retention	87%	90%	93%
MRR	~$150	$350	$700

6. Key Gaps Flagged

14 of 16 planned emails exist as HTML but are NOT registered or triggered — no backend automation is in place for the nudge sequence.

"72 hours to first order" claim in V1 welcome email is unverified — 0 orders confirmed in session recordings.

Email template file numbering doesn't match strategy doc numbering — causes confusion when cross-referencing templates and plans.

Share rate is entirely untracked — the most critical activation action (sharing the store link) has no measurement whatsoever.

ICP segmentation has not been applied to any live onboarding touchpoint — all vendors get the same generic flow.

No backend trigger logic exists for the nudge email sequence — even if templates are registered in SendGrid, they can't fire without dev work on time-delay + completion-state checks.